

Kinsus Interconnect Technology (3189 TT)

Share price (31 Aug): TWD819.00

12-mth rating: Buy (1)

Information Technology: Taiwan

Key takeaways from investor conference call

Sheng Cheng

(886) 2 8758 6253

sheng.cheng@daiwacm-cathay.com.tw

Summary: We hosted an online investor conference call for Kinsus after trading hours on 31 August. We believe that management's current revenue target is 15% QoQ growth in 3Q26 (vs. market expectation of 10% QoQ). Regarding the investigation into Unimicron's original place of production, the company noted that it has not seen any order shift from end customers. However, it believes this event will not be a negative factor for other substrate makers. In addition, Kinsus' 9% share price decline today has nothing to do with the investigation into Unimicron. Rather, it is more likely related to its parent company's plan to sell 16 million shares in Kinsus (announced last Friday). Kinsus believes this was driven by financial management considerations, and not by any specific intention to reduce its stake in Kinsus. If Kinsus' share price continues to rise, management does not rule out the possibility that its parent company may trim its stake again. Overall, we believe Kinsus' fundamentals remain largely in line with our expectations, with raw material prices continuing to rise and substrate supply tightening gradually. We maintain our Buy (1) rating on the stock, with a 12-month target price of TWD1,068, based on a 36x PER on the 1-year forward EPS. Key downside risks include weaker-than-expected demand for memory, PCs, gaming GPUs, and AI servers.

We hosted an online conference call for Kinsus after trading hours on 31 August. Overall, we believe the business outlook to be largely on track with our previous note (link [here](#), published on 31 July). Below are our key takeaways from the conference.

Recent updates:

- We believe the company has revised up its 3Q26 revenue growth target from 10% QoQ to 15% QoQ, reflecting a better-than-expected benefit from price increases. Looking ahead to 4Q26, management still expects growth of 10% QoQ, in line with its previous comments.
- Revenue mix in 2Q26: ABF 45%, BT 38%, and contact lens 17%. Looking ahead, the company expects the revenue mix from ABF to gradually increase to 50–55% in 2027.

Price hike & margin expansion:

- The company maintains its target of a 7-8% ASP increase per quarter in 2H26 to reflect rising costs of raw materials, including glass fibre, copper foil, drill bits, and ABF build-up film.
- Although some competitors have highlighted a much larger magnitude of price hikes, Kinsus has not seen a similar level of increase. The company also believes the price hike level for ABF will be higher than that for BT in 2H26, whereas in 1H26 the price hike for BT was higher than that for ABF.
- Looking into 2H26 and 2027, the company expects raw material ASPs to continue rising. As such, single-digit price hikes should be possible, with raw materials currently accounting for 30% of BT's COGS. In addition, the driver of ASP increases is expected to gradually shift from raw material inflation to substrate capacity shortages.
- In terms of gross margin expansion, Kinsus believes this will be driven mainly by an improved product mix and rising utilisation rates, rather than price hikes. This is similar to Unimicron. However, NYPCB's gross margin expansion could be driven by internal price hikes within the Nanya Group.

Utilisation rates (UTR):

- ABF: The company expects the UTR to increase from 85% (beginning of 2026) to 95% (at the end of 2026).
- BT: The company expects the UTR to increase from 75% (beginning of 2026) to 85% (at the end of 2026).

Capacity expansion plan

- Given capacity constraints, Kinsus will gradually expand its ABF capacity. It currently has around a 40 million ABF substrate capacity per month and plans to increase this to 80 million by 2029.
- According to management, the major equipment pull-in cycle will occur in 2027. After that, most equipment will be subsidised by end customers, and the depreciation expense should decline to TWD6.5-7.0bn from 2028 onward, versus TWD7.1-7.2bn in 2026 and 2027.
- As depreciation currently accounts for 15% of COGS, Kinsus believes it will reduce its selling prices slightly after clients begin subsidising the equipment, as the benefit will be shared between clients and Kinsus, at 7-8% each.

New growth opportunities – ABF

- We believe Kinsus will secure a higher allocation for both CPU and GPU products from a global leading GPU brand in its next-generation products, given the current industry's supply constraints.
- The company also believes it will provide additional support to other GPU brands for their GPU products from 2027.
- Outside of GPUs, the company sees less progress in the ASIC segment for now compared with GPUs. It has secured around a 10% allocation for one major ASIC product, but progress in other ASIC products remains relatively limited.

New growth opportunities – BT

- The company believes pluggable optical modules and market share gains (as competitors gradually exit the BT market) will be key growth drivers for Kinsus.
- According to management, the BT substrate used in optical modules will have 14 layers, compared with the mainstream 4-layer format today. Its existing equipment can support both 4-layer and 14-layer BT substrates. However, the company may need to add some routing capacity to support optical module demand.

In the interests of timeliness, this document has not been edited.

Important Disclosures and Disclaimer

This publication is produced by Daiwa Securities Group Inc. and/or its non-U.S. affiliates, and distributed by Daiwa Securities Group Inc. and/or its non-U.S. affiliates, except to the extent expressly provided herein. This publication and the contents hereof are intended for information purposes only, and may be subject to change without further notice. Any use, disclosure, distribution, dissemination, copying, printing or reliance on this publication for any other purpose without our prior consent or approval is strictly prohibited. Neither Daiwa Securities Group Inc. nor any of its respective parent, holding, subsidiaries or affiliates, nor any of its respective directors, officers, servants and employees, represent nor warrant the accuracy or completeness of the information contained herein or as to the existence of other facts which might be significant, and will not accept any responsibility or liability whatsoever for any use of or reliance upon this publication or any of the contents hereof. Neither this publication, nor any content hereof, constitute, or are to be construed as, an offer or solicitation of an offer to buy or sell any of the securities or investments mentioned herein in any country or jurisdiction nor, unless expressly provided, any recommendation or investment opinion or advice. Any view, recommendation, opinion or advice expressed in this publication may not necessarily reflect those of Daiwa Securities Group Inc., and/or its affiliates nor any of its respective directors, officers, servants and employees except where the publication states otherwise. This research report is not to be relied upon by any person in making any investment decision or otherwise advising with respect to, or dealing in, the securities mentioned, as it does not take into account the specific investment objectives, financial situation and particular needs of any person.

Daiwa Securities Group Inc., its subsidiaries or affiliates, or its or their respective directors, officers and employees from time to time have trades as principals, or have positions in, or have other interests in the securities of the company under research including market making activities, derivatives in respect of such securities or may have also performed investment banking and other services for the issuer of such securities. Daiwa Securities Group Inc., its subsidiaries or affiliates do and seek to do business with the company(s) covered in this research report. Therefore, investors should be aware that a conflict of interest may exist. The following are additional disclosures.

Licensed and proprietary artificial intelligence (AI) tools may be utilized, where appropriate, as part of the research production process. Such tools may assist with activities including information gathering, data compilation and drafting support. Any AI-assisted output is subject to appropriate review and professional judgment. Research reports are prepared and published in accordance with applicable laws, regulations, and professional standards.

Ownership of Securities

For "Ownership of Securities" information, please visit BlueMatrix disclosure link at <https://daiwa3.bluematrix.com/sellside/Disclosures.action>.

Investment Banking Relationship

For "Investment Banking Relationship", please visit BlueMatrix disclosure link at <https://daiwa3.bluematrix.com/sellside/Disclosures.action>.

Daiwa Securities Co. Ltd. and Daiwa Securities Group Inc.

Daiwa Securities Co. Ltd. is a subsidiary of Daiwa Securities Group Inc.

Investment Banking Relationship

Within the preceding 12 months, Daiwa Capital Markets Hong Kong Limited has lead-managed public offerings and/or secondary offerings of the equities or relevant securities of the following companies: WeRide Inc (800 HK/ WRD US), SEYOND (2665 HK) and SENASIC Electronics Technology Co Ltd (6675 HK).

*Subsidiaries of Daiwa Securities Group Inc. for the purposes of this section shall mean any one or more of: Daiwa Capital Markets Hong Kong Limited (大和資本市場香港有限公司), Daiwa Capital Markets Singapore Limited, Daiwa Capital Markets Australia Limited, Daiwa-Cathay Capital Markets Co., Ltd., Daiwa Securities Capital Markets Korea Co., Ltd.

Within the last 12 months, the subsidiaries and/or affiliates of Daiwa Securities Group Inc. * has received compensation for investment banking services from NH Investment & Securities Co Ltd (005940 KS), E-Mart Inc (139480 KS), Samsung Securities Co Ltd (016360 KS), KT Corporation (030200 KS) and Hyundai Department Store Co Ltd (069960 KS).

Hong Kong

This research is distributed in Hong Kong by Daiwa Capital Markets Hong Kong Limited (大和資本市場香港有限公司) ("DHK") which is regulated by the Hong Kong Securities and Futures Commission. Recipients of this research in Hong Kong may contact DHK in respect of any matter arising from or in connection with this research.

Investment Banking Relationship

Within the preceding 12 months, Daiwa Capital Markets Hong Kong Limited has lead-managed public offerings and/or secondary offerings of the equities or relevant securities of the following companies: WeRide Inc (800 HK/ WRD US), SEYOND (2665 HK) and SENASIC Electronics Technology Co Ltd (6675 HK).

Within the preceding 12 months, Daiwa Capital Markets Hong Kong Limited has received compensation for investment banking services from -.

Relevant Relationship (DHK)

DHK may from time to time have an individual employed by or associated with it serves as an officer of any of the companies under its research coverage.

Singapore

This research is distributed in Singapore by Daiwa Capital Markets Singapore Limited and it may only be distributed in Singapore to accredited investors, expert investors and institutional investors as defined in the Financial Advisers Regulations of Singapore and the Securities and Futures Act 2001 of Singapore, both as amended from time to time. By virtue of distribution to these category of investors, Daiwa Capital Markets Singapore Limited and its representatives are not required to comply with Section 45 of the Financial Advisers Act 2001 of Singapore (Section 45 relates to disclosure of Daiwa Capital Markets Singapore Limited's interest and/or any associated or connected person's interest in securities). Recipients of this research in Singapore may contact Daiwa Capital Markets Singapore Limited in respect of any matter arising from or in connection with this research.

Australia

This research is distributed in Australia by Daiwa Capital Markets Australia Limited and it may only be distributed in Australia to wholesale investors within the meaning of the Corporations Act. Recipients of this research in Australia may contact Daiwa Capital Markets Stockbroking Limited in respect of any matter arising from or in connection with the research.

Taiwan

This research is solely for reference and not intended to provide tailored investment recommendations. This research is distributed in Taiwan by Daiwa-Cathay Capital Markets Co., Ltd. and it may only be distributed in Taiwan to specific customers who have signed recommendation contracts with Daiwa-Cathay Capital Markets Co., Ltd. and non-customers including (i) professional institutional investors, (ii) TWSE or TPEX listed companies, upstream and downstream vendors, and specialists that offer or seek advice, and (iii) potential customers with an actual need for business development in accordance with the Operational Regulations Governing Securities Firms Recommending Trades in Securities to Customers. Recipients of this research including non-customer recipients of this research shall not provide it to others or engage in any activities in connection with this research which may involve conflicts of interests. Neither Daiwa-Cathay Capital Markets Co., Ltd. nor its personnel who writes or reviews the research report has any conflict of interest in this research. Since Daiwa-Cathay Capital Markets Co., Ltd. does not operate brokerage trading business in foreign markets, **this research is prepared on a "without recommendation" to any foreign securities basis** and Daiwa-Cathay Capital Markets Co., Ltd. does not accept orders from customers to trade in such foreign securities. Recipients of this research shall carefully judge their own investment risk and take full responsibility for the results of any resulting investments in the companies and/or sectors featured in this research. Without the prior written permission of Daiwa-Cathay Capital Markets Co., Ltd., recipients of this research are prohibited from disclosing the research to the media, reprinting the research, or quoting from the research to other parties. Recipients of this research in Taiwan may contact Daiwa-Cathay Capital Markets Co., Ltd. in respect of any matter arising from or in connection with the research.

Thailand

This research is distributed to only institutional investors in Thailand. This report is provided to you for informational purposes only. Information contained herein is not intended to be, and shall not be construed as, an offer or an invitation for subscription or purchase of securities in Thailand. This document has not been and will not be registered with, or approved by, the Office of the Securities and Exchange Commission of Thailand. As neither Daiwa Securities Group Inc. nor any of its subsidiaries or affiliates, nor any of the foregoing entities' respective directors, officers, servants and employees are licensed to carry on any securities business in Thailand, this document is intended to be read by the addressee who is an institutional investor only and may not be circulated or distributed, whether directly or indirectly, to the public or any members of the public in Thailand, unless to the extent permitted by applicable laws and regulations.

This report is prepared by analysts who are employed by Daiwa Securities Group Inc. and/or its non-U.S. affiliates. Neither Daiwa Securities Group Inc. nor any of its subsidiaries or affiliates, nor any of the foregoing entities' respective directors, officers, servants and employees accept any liability whatsoever for any direct or consequential loss arising from any use of this research or its contents.

The information and opinions contained herein have been compiled or arrived at from sources believed to be reliable. However, neither Daiwa Securities Group Inc. nor any of its subsidiaries or affiliates, nor any of the foregoing entities' respective directors, officers, servants and employees make any representation or warranty, express or implied, as to their accuracy or completeness. Expressions of opinion herein are subject to change without notice. The use of any information, forecasts and opinions contained in this report shall be at the sole discretion and risk of the user.

Daiwa Securities Group Inc., its subsidiaries and affiliates and their respective directors, officers, servants and employees may have positions and financial interest in securities mentioned in this research. Daiwa Securities Group Inc. and its subsidiaries and affiliates may from time to time perform investment banking or other services for, or solicit investment banking or other business from, any entity mentioned in this research. Therefore, investors should be aware of conflict of interest that may affect the objectivity of this research.

United Kingdom

These materials constitute independent research for the purposes of the Financial Conduct Authority ("FCA") Conduct of Business Rules. These materials have been produced by Daiwa Securities Co. Ltd ("DSCL") and/or its affiliates and are distributed by Daiwa Capital Markets Europe Limited ("DCME") to persons classified as (i) eligible counterparties; and (ii) professional clients for the purposes of the Conduct of Business Rules of the FCA. These materials should not be disseminated to any retail clients in the United Kingdom. DCME is authorised and regulated by the FCA and is a member of the London Stock Exchange. DCME's FCA registration number is 124490 and the FCA's registered address is 25 The North Colonnade, London, E14 5HS. DCME makes no representation as to the completeness, accuracy or timeliness of any of the materials produced by DSCL, and does not accept any liability for any losses, costs, liabilities or expenses which may arise directly or indirectly from any use of, or reliance on the materials.

DCME and/or its affiliates may, from time to time, to the extent permitted by law, participate or invest in, or be mandated in respect of transactions with the issuer(s) referred to in the materials prepared by DSCL, perform services for or solicit business from such issuers, and/or have a position or effect transactions in a particular issuer's securities and/or may have acted as an underwriter during the past twelve months in respect of a particular issuer of its securities. DCME does not review DSCL's materials prior to publication on DCME's platforms and has no influence over its content. DCME has in place organisational arrangements for the prevention and avoidance of conflicts of interest, including information barriers to control the flow of information between the private and public sides of the firm. A summary of DCME's conflict management policies are available at <http://www.uk.daiwacm.com/about-us/corporate-governance-regulatory>.

DSCL's materials are distributed by DCME only as permitted by law. The materials are not directed to, or intended for distribution to or use by, any person or entity located in any jurisdiction where such distribution, publication, availability or use would be contrary to law or regulation or would subject DCME to any regulation or licensing requirement within such jurisdiction.

Germany

Research reports are produced by Daiwa Securities Co. Ltd. and/or its affiliates and are distributed by Daiwa Capital Markets Deutschland GmbH in the European Union. Daiwa Capital Markets Deutschland GmbH is authorised and regulated by Bundesanstalt für Finanzdienstleistungsaufsicht ("BaFin") under the reference number 149361. Daiwa Capital Markets Deutschland GmbH and its affiliates may, from time to time, to the extent permitted by law, participate or invest in, or be mandated in respect of, other financing transactions with the issuer(s) of the securities referred to herein (the "Securities"), perform services for or solicit business from such issuers, and/or have a position or effect transactions in the Securities or options thereof.

This publication is intended for investors who are Professional Clients or Eligible Counterparties in the European Union within the meaning of Directive 2014/65/EU ("MiFID II") and should therefore not be distributed to Retail Clients in the European Union.

Daiwa Capital Markets Deutschland GmbH has in place organisational arrangements for the identification, prevention and management of conflicts of interest. Information regarding our conflict management are available at: <https://www.de.daiwacm.com/policies/>

Additional disclosures regarding specific company names and related financial instruments are available at: <https://daiwa3.bluematrix.com/sellside/Disclosures.action>.

Bahrain

This research material is distributed in Bahrain by Daiwa Capital Markets Europe Limited, Bahrain Branch, regulated by The Central Bank of Bahrain and holds Investment Business Firm – Category 2 license and having its official place of business at the Bahrain World Trade Centre, South Tower, 7th floor, P.O. Box 30069, Manama, Kingdom of Bahrain. Tel No. +973 17534452 Fax No. +973 535113

United States

This research is distributed into the United States directly by Daiwa Capital Markets Hong Kong Limited (DCMHK) and in certain cases indirectly by Daiwa Capital Markets America Inc. (DCMA), a U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission registered broker-dealer and FINRA member firm, exclusively to "major U.S. institutional investors", as defined under Rule 15a-6 promulgated under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934, as amended, and as interpreted by the staff of the U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC). Where this is co-branded research published by Daiwa's partners in collaboration with other parties not affiliated with Daiwa, this research is distributed in the United States by DCMHK only. This report is not an offer to sell or the solicitation of any offer to buy securities. U.S. customers wishing to effect transactions in any designated investment discussed in this report should do so through a qualified salesperson of DCMA. Non-U.S. customers wishing to effect transactions in any designated investment discussed in this report should contact a Daiwa entity in their local jurisdiction. The securities or other investment products discussed in this report may not be eligible for sale in some jurisdictions.

Analysts employed outside the U.S., as specifically indicated elsewhere in this report, are not registered as research analysts with FINRA. These analysts may not be associated persons of DCMA, and therefore may not be subject to FINRA Rule 2241 restrictions on communications with a subject company, public appearances and trading securities held by a research analyst account.

ADDITIONAL IMPORTANT DISCLOSURES CAN BE FOUND AT:

<https://daiwa3.bluematrix.com/sellside/Disclosures.action>

Ownership of Securities

For "Ownership of Securities" information please visit BlueMatrix disclosure link at <https://daiwa3.bluematrix.com/sellside/Disclosures.action>.

Investment Banking Relationships

For "Investment Banking Relationships" please visit BlueMatrix disclosure link at <https://daiwa3.bluematrix.com/sellside/Disclosures.action>.

DCMA Market Making

For "DCMA Market Making" please visit BlueMatrix disclosure link at <https://daiwa3.bluematrix.com/sellside/Disclosures.action>.

Research Analyst Conflicts

For updates on "Research Analyst Conflicts" please visit BlueMatrix disclosure link at <https://daiwa3.bluematrix.com/sellside/Disclosures.action>. The principal research analysts who prepared this report have no financial interest in securities of the issuers covered in the report, are not (nor are any members of their household) an officer, director or advisory board member of the issuer(s) covered in the report, and are not aware of any material relevant conflict of interest involving the analyst or DCMA, and did not receive any compensation from the issuer during the past 12 months except as noted: no exceptions.

Research Analyst Certification

For updates on "Research Analyst Certification" and "Rating System" please visit BlueMatrix disclosure link at <https://daiwa3.bluematrix.com/sellside/Disclosures.action>. The views about any and all of the subject securities and issuers expressed in this Research Report accurately reflect the personal views of the research analyst(s) primarily responsible for this report (or the views of the firm producing the report if no individual analyst is named on the report); and no part of the compensation of such analyst (or no part of the compensation of the firm if no individual analyst is named on the report) was, is, or will be directly or indirectly related to the specific recommendations or views contained in this Research Report.

The following explains the rating system in the report as compared to relevant local indices, unless otherwise stated, based on the beliefs of the author of the report.

- "1": the security could outperform the local index by more than 15% over the next 12 months.
- "2": the security is expected to outperform the local index by 5-15% over the next 12 months.
- "3": the security is expected to perform within 5% of the local index (better or worse) over the next 12 months.
- "4": the security is expected to underperform the local index by 5-15% over the next 12 months.
- "5": the security could underperform the local index by more than 15% over the next 12 months.

Disclosure of investment ratings

Rating	Percentage of total
Buy*	72.63%
Hold**	20.53%
Sell***	6.84%

Source: Daiwa

Notes: data is for single-branded Daiwa research in Asia (ex Japan) and correct as of 30 June 2026.

* comprised of Daiwa's Buy and Outperform ratings.

** comprised of Daiwa's Hold ratings.

*** comprised of Daiwa's Underperform and Sell ratings.

Additional information may be available upon request.

Japan - Notification items pursuant to Article 37 of the Financial Instruments and Exchange Law

(This Notification is only applicable to where report is distributed by Daiwa Securities Co. Ltd.)

If you decide to enter into a business arrangement with our company based on the information described in this report, we ask you to pay close attention to the following items.

- In addition to the purchase price of a financial instrument, our company will collect a trading commission* for each transaction as agreed beforehand with you. Since commissions may be included in the purchase price or may not be charged for certain transactions, we recommend that you confirm the commission for each transaction. In some cases, our company also may charge a maximum of ¥2 million per year as a standing proxy fee for our deposit of your securities, if you are a non-resident.

- For derivative and margin transactions etc., our company may require collateral or margin requirements in accordance with an agreement made beforehand with you. Ordinarily in such cases, the amount of the transaction will be in excess of the required collateral or margin requirements**.
 - There is a risk that you will incur losses on your transactions due to changes in the market price of financial instruments based on fluctuations in interest rates, exchange rates, stock prices, real estate prices, commodity prices, and others. In addition, depending on the content of the transaction, the loss could exceed the amount of the collateral or margin requirements.
 - There may be a difference between bid price etc. and ask price etc. of OTC derivatives handled by our company.
 - Before engaging in any trading, please thoroughly confirm accounting and tax treatments regarding your trading in financial instruments with such experts as certified public accountants.
- * The amount of the trading commission cannot be stated here in advance because it will be determined between our company and you based on current market conditions and the content of each transaction etc.
- ** The ratio of margin requirements etc. to the amount of the transaction cannot be stated here in advance because it will be determined between our company and you based on current market conditions and the content of each transaction etc.

When making an actual transaction, please be sure to carefully read the materials presented to you prior to the execution of agreement, and to take responsibility for your own decisions regarding the signing of the agreement with our company.

Corporate Name:	Daiwa Securities Co. Ltd.
Registered:	Financial Instruments Business Operator, Chief of Kanto Local Finance Bureau (Kin-sho) No.108
Memberships:	Japan Securities Dealers Association, The Financial Futures Association of Japan, Investment Management Association of Japan, Type II Financial Instruments Firms Association, Japan Security Token Offering Association